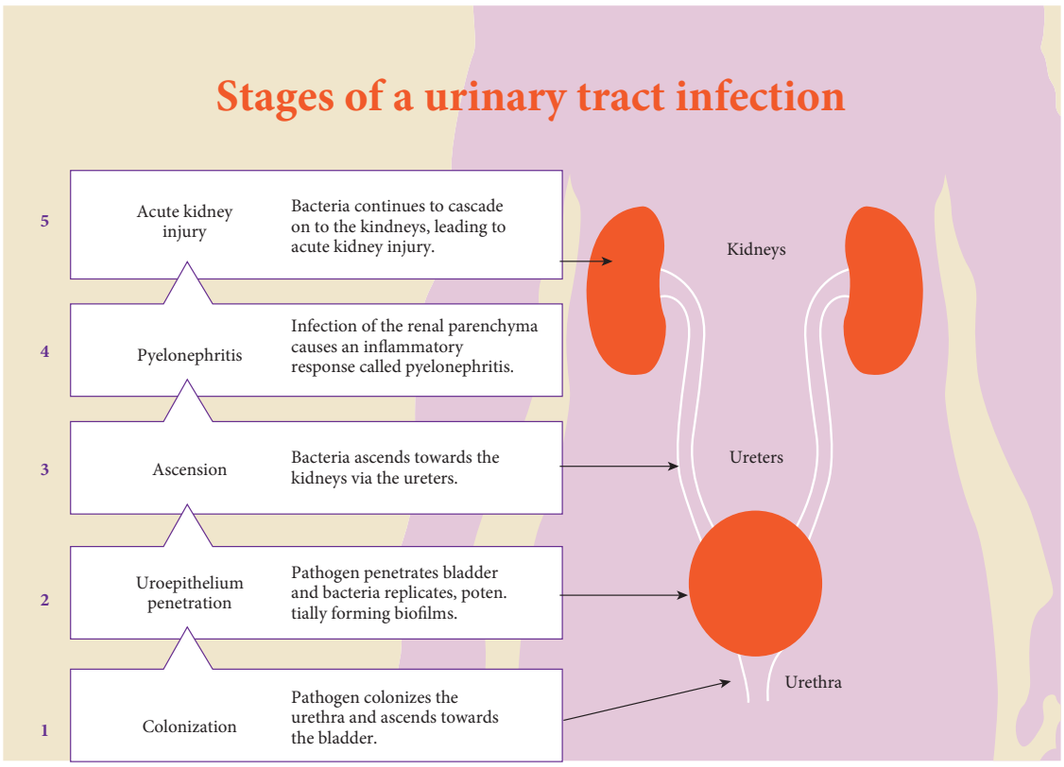


Figure 12.16: Various stages of a urinary tract infection

12.7 Reproductive Tract Infections

Reproductive tract infections are caused by organisms normally present in the reproductive or genital tract or introduced from the outside during sexual contact or medical procedures. It occur both in men and women. Based on mode of infection reproductive tract infections are classified into three types:

1. Sexually Transmitted Disease

It is caused through means of sexual contact. Examples: Chlamydia, Gonnorhea, Chancroid, and Acquired Immuno Deficiency Syndrome (AIDS).

2. Endogenous Infections

These are caused by the overgrowth of organisms normally present in the genital tract of healthy women. Example: Bacterial Vaginosis or Vulvo Vaginal Candidiasis.

3. Iatrogenic Infections

These infections are associated with improperly performed medical procedures such as unsafe abortion or poor delivery practices. The endogenous organisms in the vagina or sexually transmitted organisms in the cervix may be transferred during a transcervical procedure into the upper reproductive tract and cause serious infections of the uterus, fallopian tubes, and other pelvic organs.

In men reproductive tract infections transmitted by sexual contact are much more common than by endogenous or iatrogenic reproductive infections. In women reproductive infections spread through non sexual routes are usually more common.

TN_GOVT_XI_Micro_Biology_CH12.indd 200 16-02-2019 10.05.46 AM